

Outlook

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Follow-up: which service fails first under operating stress?

Morning,

I need help with something that sounds simple but probably is not.

The resilience plan lists systems, but customers experience end-to-end services that cross ATM, card, transaction and communication processes. The timing also overlaps with Record Stage 6 load shedding across major metros. Treat that as context to test, not an answer. The operating teams agree that more journeys are failing; they disagree on whether the customer, the bank or a downstream party owns the failure.

The questions I would ask in the room are:

1. What would we expect to see if manual workarounds create later reconciliation breaks?
2. What evidence would instead support that recovery restores authorisation before posting catches up?
3. How do we rule out that cash access degrades before account servicing?

This has returned because the previous answer was useful but not strong enough to become a standing rule. Use July 2022 as the new evidence point rather than recycling the earlier conclusion. Please work towards the order in which critical services should be recovered and tested. A useful output would be a model-ready table, data dictionary and an honest baseline.

Use transaction-level timestamps, channels, amounts, statuses and error context; ATM attempts, host responses, PIN attempts, blocked-card state and latency; customer contacts, complaints and suggestions; debit-order mandates, collection dates, suspensions and cancellations. One caution: Treat this as a historical service-impact rehearsal, not proof of infrastructure capacity.

Regards